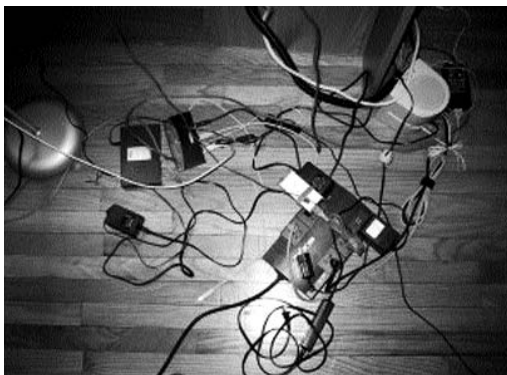


How can anything that broadcasts everything sent or received through the air be secure?

This is perhaps a question that each and everyone of us has thought at some point or another. And the truth is, Wireless LANs (WLANs) are a lot less secure than their wired counterparts. Perhaps WLANs are not the best solution for the paranoid, but then again, neither is the Internet. The mother of all networks, the Internet, has become the single biggest threat to the security and privacy of the millions that use it, yet the number of people using it is increasing by millions every year. The only safe computer is one that isn't networked at all, and has no Internet connection, but who wants that?

It's obvious that every good thing comes with its price, and WLANs are no different. Yes your data is more at risk than those on a regular wired LAN; yes your computer can be hacked into using your wireless card; however, bypassing the security that you can set up for your WLAN is something only a professional hacker could do, and chances are, if a professional hacker wants to get into your computer that badly, he probably already has access-WLAN or not.



In this chapter, we will list out some of the known vulnerabilities to WLANs, and also give you a look at the security software that can help overcome these vulnerabilities.